



Usual suspects, goodbyes, and some respite

For some, 2024 was business as usual.

India celebrated three world champions at the Para World Badminton Championships: Pramod Bhagat, Suhas Yathiraj, and Krishna Nagar. The Indian contingent wrapped up the tournament with 18 medals. At the All England Open, Indonesia's Jonatan Christie secured his maiden title, while Spain's Carolina Marin clinched her second, ending a nine-year gap since her first win.

China dominated both the Thomas and Uber Cups, defeating Indonesia in the finals of both competitions to assert dominance.

The year was also an emotional one for many in the badminton world.

Tai Tzu Ying began the final season of her illustrious career with a title win at the India Open, held at New Delhi's KD Jadhav Indoor Stadium. At just 29, Japan's Kento Momota, a two-time world champion, announced his retirement from international badminton, though he plans to continue competing in Japan's domestic circuit.

India's B. Sai Praneeth, a 2019 World Championship bronze medallist, also decided to step away from international badminton. Similarly, China's He Bingjiao, after clinching silver at the Paris Olympics, announced her retirement from the sport at the highest level.

Another notable departure came from Mathias Boe, whose retirement from coaching marked the end of a significant chapter. Boe, an Olympic

Historic: Gayatri Gopichand and Treesa Jolly became the first Indian women's pair to clinch the doubles title at Syed Modi International. GETTY IMAGES

silver medallist and the coach of Satwik-Chirag, made his decision public after the Indian duo's quarterfinal exit at the Paris Olympics, a moment that surely left both players emotional.

But the year ended on a positive note for Indian badminton.

Satwik and Chirag returned to action after a three-month break following their Olympic disappointment. The pair reached the semifinals of the China Masters and had a mixed year overall, regaining the World No. 1 ranking at one stage and clinching titles at the French and